CONFIDENTIAL — CANDIDATE BRIEFING

Kebony ERP Implementation

Full-scope Odoo 19 deployment for a vertically integrated timber manufacturer — from raw wood reception to finished-goods costing, across Belgium manufacturing, US distribution, and Nordic entities.

Platform: Odoo 19 (SaaS + Custom Addons) Go-live: July 1, 2026 Last updated: March 2026

1 About Kebony

Kebony is a Norwegian-origin timber technology company that manufactures premium modified wood products. The proprietary **Kebonisation** process chemically impregnates sustainably sourced softwoods (Scots Pine, Radiata Pine) to achieve hardwood-grade durability and aesthetics — used globally for cladding, decking, and construction.

~490	5	3	1
PRODUCT SKUS	LEGAL ENTITIES	COUNTRIES	MANUFACTURING PLANT

70+
MASTER ITEMS

Legal Structure

Kebony Holding
Belgium — Group parent, product master data owner

Kebony BNV

Kebony Inc.

Kebony Norge AS

Belgium — Manufacturing (Kallo plant)

USA — Distribution, consignment, accruals

Norway — Legacy entity

Kebony KAS
Norway — Legacy entity

Entity localisation — Feature visibility is gated per company via `x_kebony_entity_type`. US-only features (accruals, margin analysis, BOL reports, consignment) only appear for Kebony Inc. Manufacturing features (planning families, dryer loads, BoMs) only appear for Kebony BNV.

2 Project Scope

The project replaces a legacy Microsoft AX 2012 system with Odoo 19. It covers the full operational footprint — from procurement and manufacturing to sales, accounting, and management reporting.

Odoo Standard Applications

APPLICATION	SCOPE	ENTITY
Sales	Quotations, orders, pack reservation, BOL reports, distributor pricing	All
Purchase	Procurement, consignment PO generation, landed costs	All (consignment: US)
Inventory	Multi-warehouse (Kallo, TabakNatie, RDK), lot tracking, quality grading	All
Manufacturing	Dryer-centric planning, process packs, autoclave batches, BoMs	BNV
Accounting	FIFO valuation, Anglo-Saxon COGS, accrual engine, multi-entity	All (accruals: US)
HR & Payroll	Employee management, payroll (phased — live September 2026)	All
Knowledge	Synced from project documentation vault (Obsidian → Odoo)	All

Custom Addon Modules

kebony_bol_report ACTIVE

Main customisation module — the backbone. 29 model files covering:

kebony_manufacturing ACTIVE

Manufacturing planning layer — 8 model files covering:

- Physical metrics layer (linear m, boards, volume m³)
- COGS, margin & accrual computation (US)
- Pack reservation on sales orders
- Consignment pricing & Biewer PO generation
- BOL, quotation, invoice report templates
- Landed cost integration

- Planning Families (species/profile parameters)
- Dryer Loads (= Manufacturing Orders)
- Autoclave Batches (2 per Dryer Load)
- Process Packs (physical units, no accounting)
- Cost Version framework (budgeted WC rates)
- DL Proposal Wizard (demand → schedule)

vvf_multi_ledger ACTIVE

Alternative ledger engine for managerial / IFRS parallel reporting. Currently in use at Kebony Holding. IFRS journal entries and dedicated visualisation are the remaining development items.

kebony_uom_migration DEPRECATED

One-time migration tool (Linear Inches → Linear Feet). Migration completed; module to be archived.

3 Product Architecture & SKU Complexity

Kebony's product catalogue is deceptively complex. ~70 master items (unique cross-section *sizes* — width × thickness combinations, not application profiles) fan out into ~490 sellable SKUs through combinations of **length**, **measurement system** (metric vs. imperial), and **species**. Treatments (fire retardant, colour, brushing) are tracked at **lot level only** — preventing combinatorial explosion.

3-Level Product Hierarchy (No Odoo Variants)

Master Item
e.g. 1127
Non-sellable grouping

→

Master Variant
e.g. 1127-3.2
Grouped by dimension

→

Metric Product
e.g. 1127-M-3.2
Sellable, stockable

/

Imperial Product
e.g. 1127-I-10.5
Sellable, stockable

Why no Odoo product variants? — Packaging depends on board length. A "Pack of 162 × 3.2m" and "Pack of 162 × 4.8m" are structurally incompatible in Odoo 19's merged UoM/Packaging system. Each length is a separate product template.

Measurement Doctrine — Three Dimensions

DIMENSION	UNIT	ROLE
Linear	Meters (normalised internally)	Operational — stock movements, sales orders

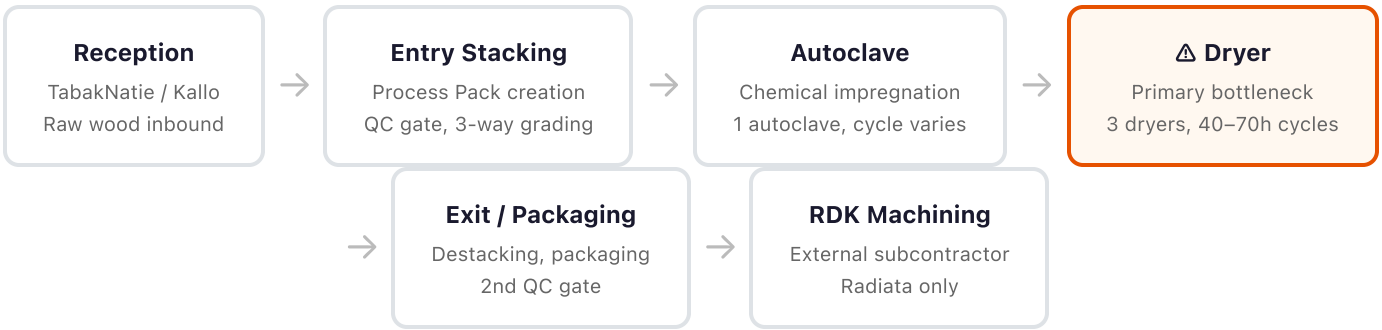
Board Count	Integer (rounded up at 0.95 threshold)	Logistics — packaging, board-by-board QC
Volume (m³)	Cubic meters	**Economic truth** — all costs, margins, KPIs reconcile to m³

The `KebonyMetricsMixin` abstract model provides unified computation across stock quants, lots, moves, sale/invoice lines — ensuring one formula, everywhere. 89 fields per product template cover identity, geometry (metric + imperial), packaging, compliance, manufacturing, and computed stock.

4 Manufacturing Process

The Kallo plant operates a **dryer-centric flow process**. Three dryers are the bottleneck resource — everything schedules backward from dryer capacity. The process transforms raw (white) wood into Kebonised (brown) wood through chemical impregnation and controlled drying.

Production Flow



Planning Hierarchy

OBJECT	RELATIONSHIP	ACCOUNTING IMPACT
Process Pack (PP)	5–8 per Autoclave Batch	None — physical metadata only
Autoclave Batch (AC)	2 per Dryer Load	None — physical metadata only
Dryer Load (DL)	= 1 Manufacturing Order	**Accounting boundary** — WIP → FG valuation

> **Key principle:** 1 Dryer Load = 1 Manufacturing Order = 1 costing unit. No SKU multiplication — Process Packs and Autoclave Batches are traceability metadata, not product variants. Family compatibility rule: only same-family products share loads (impregnation/drying profiles must match).

Species Characteristics

Scots Pine

- Origin: Sweden
- Pre-machined before Kebonisation
- 2–3× longer autoclave processing
- 55–80h dryer cycles
- Higher conversion cost per m³

Radiata Pine

- Origin: New Zealand
- Rough sawn — machined post-treatment (RDK)
- Faster autoclave processing
- ~54h dryer cycles
- Lower conversion, higher machining cost

5 Costing & Accounting Model

The project represents a paradigm shift from the legacy AX approach. Key decisions validated at SteerCo (March 2026):

Anglo-Saxon Accounting

Inventory on balance sheet; COGS recognised at delivery (not invoice). IAS 2 / IFRS compliant. Cleaner journal structure than Continental approach.

FIFO Inventory Valuation

Finished goods at actual cost (lot-tracked). Replaces standard cost with quarterly revaluation. Eliminates 800+ standard cost maintenance items → 3 work centre rates.

Actual COGS Decomposition

Each lot carries its real cost breakdown from the Manufacturing Order — wood, chemicals, conversion, machining. Margin reports show *why* costs changed.

3-Stage Cost Absorption

Raw materials (FIFO purchase) + Conversion (standard rate × actual hours per WC: Stacking, Autoclave, Dryer) + Subcontracting (RDK machining). All absorbed into WIP → FG.

US-Specific: Accrual Engine

Kebony Inc. has a revenue-based accrual system computed at invoice posting — marketing, royalties, management fees, sales rep charges. Consignment products (Biewer Lumber) are excluded from royalties and management fees. Consignment uses a dedicated pricing table rather than FIFO cost.

6 Multi-Entity Localisation

Each entity has distinct accounting, operational, and reporting requirements. The system uses a feature-gating pattern based on company type to ensure the right features appear for the right users.

ENTITY	COUNTRY	CHART OF ACCOUNTS	KEY FEATURES
Kebony Inc.	USA	US GAAP	COGS & margin, accruals (marketing, royalties, mgmt fees), consignment (Biewer), BOL reports, prepayments, landed costs
Kebony BNV	Belgium	Belgian PCMN	Manufacturing (dryer loads, planning families, BoMs), WIP accounting, intercompany, 3PL (TabakNatie)
Kebony Holding	Belgium	Belgian PCMN	Product master data ownership, shared product templates, group consolidation
Norge AS / KAS	Norway	Norwegian SAF-T	Legacy entities — minimal scope, factoring programme migration in progress

Factoring programme switch: Currently migrating from Norway to Belgium (2-month process). The ERP go-live and factoring switch are synchronised to avoid double disruption for customers.

7 Project Timeline

2024 — Q3/Q4

Foundation & Analysis

Vendor selection (Odoo 19), entity analysis, product master data documentation, initial blueprint.

2025 — Q1/Q2

Core Development — Phase 1

Metrics layer (KebonyMetricsMixin), stock quant/lot enrichment, sale order pack reservation, US accounting (accruals, margin, COGS), consignment flow (Biewer), BOL reports, product master migration.

2025 — Q3/Q4

Manufacturing Planning

Planning Families, Dryer Loads, Autoclave Batches, Process Packs, DL Proposal Wizard, MO generation from DL, cost version framework.

2026 — Q1

Costing Model Validation

SteerCo decision: Anglo-Saxon + FIFO (Option B+). Costing architecture blueprint validated. Accounting principles documented. Credit note handling revised. Prepayment logic delivered.

APRIL — MAY 2026

Blueprint Review & Workshops

Revisit blueprints for: costing model, security (BU + legal entity + country access), approval workflows, product master data revalidation, GDPR compliance. Implementation workshops with key users.

JUNE 2026

Readiness & UAT

Project readiness target: 1 June 2026. User Acceptance Testing, data migration dry-runs, super key user training, gate-keeping approvals.

1 JULY 2026

🟢 Go-Live

Full ERP cut-over: sales, purchasing, inventory, manufacturing, accounting. Factoring programme switch (Norway → Belgium) synchronised.

JULY — SEPTEMBER 2026

Hypercare & Stabilisation

Dedicated support period. First month-end close in Odoo. HR Payroll test run (August), payroll live (September). Management reporting evaluation.

Q4 2026

Reporting & Optimisation

Power BI / MS Fabric reporting (full scope confirmation). Quarterly SKU margin averaging. Budget vs. actual gap analysis embedded. Campaigning scope live (if confirmed). Transition to maintenance mode.

2027+

Maintenance & Evolution

Ongoing maintenance, Odoo version upgrades, MES feedback layer (Phase 9), potential multi-ledger activation, advanced analytics.

8 Delivery Status

AREA	STATUS	DETAILS
Metrics layer (mixin)	DONE	KebonyMetricsMixin: linear m, boards, volume m³ across all models
Stock enrichment	DONE	Quant, lot, move-level metrics; pack reservation

Sales flow	DONE	Pack reservation, line metrics, BOL/quotation/invoice reports
US Accounting	DONE	COGS, margin, accruals (marketing, royalties, mgmt fees, sales rep)
Consignment (Biewer)	DONE	Pricing table, auto PO generation, no-receipt picking
Manufacturing planning	DONE	Families, DL, AC, PP, DL Proposal Wizard, MO generation
Cost version framework	DONE	Period-versioned budget/standard WC rates
Landed costs	DONE	Integration with stock valuation
Costing blueprint	DONE	Anglo-Saxon + FIFO validated at SteerCo
Blueprint reviews	IN PROGRESS	Security, approval workflows, product revalidation
MES feedback	PENDING	Phase 9 — real-time production data integration
RDK price model	PENDING	Subcontracting variance allocation (INV-1)
Supply chain rules	PENDING	MTO/ATO-WW/ATO-BW/MTS assignment per product (COO input)
HR Payroll	PENDING	Test: August 2026, Live: September 2026
Management reporting	PENDING	Power BI / MS Fabric — full scope Q4 2026

9 Implementation Methodology

The project follows a **documentation-first, AI-assisted** methodology designed to eliminate context drift between business requirements, technical specifications, and running code. Every artefact is version-controlled and cross-referenced.

1

Requirement Blueprint

Business requirements are written as structured documents in an **Obsidian vault** — Markdown files with precise terminology, field

2

Stakeholder Validation

Blueprints are presented as **HTML slide decks** (SteerCo format) for CFO/COO/CEO review

3

Knowledge Base Sync

Validated documents are synced to **Odoo Knowledge** via XML-RPC, making them accessible to

definitions, and decision rationale.

and formal sign-off. Decisions are recorded with date and rationale.

the entire team inside the ERP itself.

4

AI-Assisted Development

Code is written with **Claude** (Anthropic AI), which reads the full documentation context. CLAUDE.md files in each module ensure zero drift between spec and implementation.

5

Version Control

All code in **GitHub**. Each feature gets a dedicated git worktree and branch. PRs reviewed against the blueprint before merge to main.

Why this matters: The documentation vault, slide decks, knowledge base, and codebase all reference the same terminology, field names, and business rules. Claude reads all of them simultaneously — so when a blueprint says "FIFO + full absorption", the code implements exactly that, with the correct account numbers, field mappings, and edge cases. There is no "telephone game" between analyst, developer, and tester.

Documentation Architecture

LAYER	FORMAT	LOCATION	PURPOSE
Obsidian Vault	Markdown (.md)	Local filesystem	Source of truth — terminology, architecture, field registries, decision logs
Slide Decks	HTML + PDF	Vault / 06 - Slide Decks	SteerCo presentations, stakeholder communication, candidate briefings
Odoo Knowledge	HTML (converted)	kebonyprod.odoo.com	Team-accessible documentation inside the ERP
CLAUDE.md files	Markdown	GitHub repo (per module)	AI context — field naming, gotchas, Odoo 19 specifics, entity table
GitHub	Python / XML	Kebony-Repository	Running code — addons, migrations, tests

10 Technical Environment

ERP Platform

- Odoo 19.0 (SaaS + custom addons)

Development

- GitHub (version control)

- Python 3.12+, OWL (frontend)
- PostgreSQL

- Git worktrees (feature isolation)
- Claude AI (Anthropic) — dev assistant
- Odoo Studio (field definitions)

Documentation

- Obsidian (knowledge vault)
- HTML slide decks (presentations)
- Odoo Knowledge (team wiki)
- XML-RPC sync (automated)

Reporting (Planned)

- Power BI / MS Fabric (Q4 2026)
- Odoo native reports (BOL, invoices)
- SQL-based margin analysis

11 What You'd Be Working On

Your focus will be on the **customer-facing and commercial workstreams** — areas that are entering their blueprint and implementation phase in the coming weeks. This is a programme management role bridging business requirements and ERP configuration.

CRM & Sales Pipeline

- Lead-to-opportunity workflow design
- Sales pipeline stages and automation rules
- Distributor vs. direct customer segmentation
- Integration with existing sales processes
- Reporting dashboards (pipeline, conversion, forecasting)

Marketing

- Campaign management and tracking in Odoo
- Email marketing workflows and templates
- Lead scoring and nurturing rules
- Marketing spend tracking and ROI analysis
- Integration with CRM pipeline

Product Lifecycle Management

- Product launch / phase-out workflows
- Portfolio management (market, application, species)
- Sample management and approval processes
- Coordination with Product Master Data Guardian
- Commercial documentation and catalogues

Customer Service & Ticketing

- Helpdesk / ticketing workflow (claims, returns, quality issues)
- SLA definitions and escalation rules
- Link between tickets and sales orders / lots (traceability)
- Customer satisfaction tracking
- Knowledge base for support team (FAQ, troubleshooting)

Your role in the project: You'll own the blueprint, stakeholder workshops, UAT scenarios, and go-live readiness for these workstreams — working alongside the technical team that handles the Odoo configuration and custom development. Think programme manager, not developer.